

VINOD VULAVAKAYALA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI Platform Engineer with 6+ years building enterprise-grade cloud and AI infrastructure across Azure, Databricks, and AWS. At ExxonMobil, architected Azure OpenAI and LLM serving infrastructure on AKS supporting AI adoption across multiple business units. Deep expertise in Databricks Unity Catalog, Delta Live Tables, and MLflow-based model lifecycle management, with production Terraform modules governing cluster policies, managed identities, and RBAC at scale. Proven record accelerating release cycles, cutting compute costs, and operationalizing responsible AI governance in regulated energy sector environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud and AI Platforms: Azure, AWS, Azure OpenAI, Azure AI Foundry, Azure AI Services, Azure AI Search, Azure Document Intelligence, Azure ML, Databricks

Containers and Orchestration: Kubernetes, AKS, EKS, Docker, Helm

DevOps and CI/CD: GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, release automation, rollback workflows

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, ARM Templates, Ansible, Chef, HashiCorp Packer

MLOps and AI Frameworks: MLflow, Delta Live Tables, Unity Catalog, LangChain, Azure AI Content Safety

Programming and Scripting: Python, PowerShell, Bash, Shell scripting

Security, Networking and Monitoring: VNets, NSGs, private endpoints, firewalls, IAM, VPC, network ACLs, Azure Monitor, Splunk, AppDynamics

Systems and Databases: Linux, Windows Server, Apache, NGINX, PostgreSQL, Cosmos DB, Delta Lake, SQL, NoSQL

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Azure AI Engineer (AI-102) | Microsoft Azure Cloud Administrator (AZ-104) | Microsoft Azure Security Engineer (AZ-500) | AWS Developer Associate | Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CNCF) | Databricks Administrator

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Azure AI Engineer / Databricks AI Engineer | ExxonMobil | Houston, TX | Aug 2024 - Present

- Architected Azure OpenAI and LLM serving infrastructure on AKS, deploying Llama 3 and GPT-4 endpoints with autoscaling policies, achieving 99.99% uptime while reducing compute costs by 25% through GPU right-sizing and spot instance scheduling.
- Automated Azure AI resource provisioning using Terraform modules with managed identity, Key Vault integration, and RBAC controls, reducing deployment time by 30% and enforcing compliance guardrails across all AI workloads.
- Engineered Unity Catalog governance and MLflow model registry workflows to track model lineage, manage artifacts, and enforce fine-grained access control across Databricks AI workloads.
- Built Delta Live Tables pipelines and Databricks Jobs CI/CD automation using Azure DevOps, enabling version-controlled notebook releases, environment promotion, and automated rollback across dev, staging, and production.
- Integrated Azure AI services including AI Search, Document Intelligence, and Cognitive Services to build enterprise onboarding assistants and internal support chatbots serving multiple business units.
- Designed system prompts and tool-calling agent architectures for enterprise AI workflows; monitored token usage and applied Azure AI Content Safety policies to enforce responsible AI governance in production.
- Implemented private endpoints, VNets, NSGs, and firewall rules to isolate AI workloads and satisfy energy sector security and compliance requirements.

DevOps Engineer / MLOps Engineer | Chevron | Houston, TX | Apr 2020 - Aug 2024

- Built CI/CD pipelines using Azure DevOps, reducing deployment cycles by 50% and accelerating release frequency across multiple application teams.
- Automated infrastructure provisioning with Terraform and ARM templates, reducing manual configuration errors by 70% and enabling self-service environment creation.
- Designed and deployed AKS clusters with Terraform and Helm charts to support scalable, highly available containerized workloads.
- Migrated on-premises applications to Azure, improving performance and reducing infrastructure costs by 30%.

- Managed Azure ML workspaces and automated platform operations, reducing model training cycle time by 20%.
- Established Azure Monitor alerting and observability workflows, reducing downtime incidents by 40%.
- Developed Python, PowerShell, and Shell scripts to automate infrastructure tasks, patching cycles, and environment lifecycle management.
- Supported hybrid cloud architectures using AWS services including EC2, S3, Lambda, RDS, and EKS.
- Enhanced platform security with firewall hardening, continuous monitoring, and operational visibility through Splunk and AppDynamics.

AWS Cloud Engineer / DevOps Engineer | Phillips 66 | Houston, TX | Sep 2019 - Mar 2020

- Engineered AWS cloud solutions using EC2, S3, Lambda, RDS, and VPC to improve application scalability and performance.
- Automated AWS infrastructure provisioning with Terraform and Python, reducing environment setup time from days to minutes.
- Created reusable AMI images with HashiCorp Packer to standardize deployment and patching workflows across teams.
- Developed secure Jenkins CI/CD pipelines for internal tools and microservices, improving release speed and reliability.
- Hardened cloud environments through custom IAM policies, secure VPC configurations, and network ACLs.
- Mentored junior engineers through DevOps knowledge-sharing sessions focused on AWS and infrastructure automation best practices.

Site Reliability Engineer (Contract) | Apple | Cupertino, CA | May 2019 - Jul 2019

- Supported production systems focused on reliability, monitoring, incident response, and operational readiness.
- Participated in on-call rotations, managing incident triage, mitigation, and post-incident analysis.
- Enhanced observability by optimizing alerts and dashboards to accelerate detection of user-impacting issues.
- Reduced MTTR by developing detailed runbooks and improving incident response documentation.

DevOps Engineer / Site Reliability Engineer | Discount Tire Headquarters | Phoenix, AZ | Nov 2018 - May 2019

- Containerized applications with Docker and deployed them on Kubernetes, reducing deployment time by 50% while improving scalability.
- Built and maintained Kubernetes clusters to support high availability and performance for containerized workloads.
- Automated CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins and Kubernetes integration to streamline software delivery.
- Developed Bash, Shell, and Python scripts for system monitoring, resource management, and infrastructure maintenance.
- Configured Apache and NGINX web servers and supported PostgreSQL and NoSQL database deployments for scalable applications.

Systems Engineer | Northwestern Mutual | Milwaukee, WI | Dec 2017 - Oct 2018

- Administered Red Hat and Ubuntu Linux systems across critical infrastructure environments.
- Developed automation scripts using Python, Shell, and Ansible to streamline routine infrastructure tasks and reduce manual effort.
- Assisted migration of legacy Linux systems to updated infrastructure with minimal business disruption.
- Participated in security audits and patch management activities to maintain internal compliance standards.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree in Computer Science | University of Central Missouri | Warrensburg, MO | May 2017